# Anna De La Paz

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## Education

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| PhD in Sociology at Syracuse University | 2023 – present |
| Master's Degree in Sociology at Syracuse University | 2026 |
| Doula training at DONA International | 2025 |
| Master's Degree in Nutrition at University of Rhode Island | 2021 |
| Bachelor's Degree in Nutrition & Food Studies at Syracuse University | 2017 |

## Employment History

**Research Assistant** Aug 2023 - present
Dr. Madonna Harrington Meyer, Syracuse University

**Research Assistant** December 2024 - June 2025
Dr. Selina Gallo-Cruz, Syracuse University

**Registered Dietitian** January 2020 - July 2023

**WIC Clinic Manager and Nutritionist** June 2017 - December 2019

## Publications

**De La Paz, Anna** (Apr. 2026). "Is Home Birth a Choice? Racial and Geographic Differences in Unintended Home Births in the U.S." In: *Population Health Research Brief Series*. DOI: https://doi.org/10.14305/rt.lerner.2026.7. URL: https://surface.syr.edu/lerner/295.

**De La Paz, Anna** (Aug. 2025). "Is Health Insurance Related to Breastfeeding Duration?" In: *Population Health Research Brief Series*. DOI: https://doi.org/10.14305/rt.lerner.2025.13. URL: https://surface.syr.edu/lerner/278.

Harrington Meyer, Madonna and **De La Paz, Anna** (Jan. 2024). "Why is Food Insecurity High among U.S. Grandparents who are Caring for Grandchildren?" In: *Population Health Research Brief Series*. URL: https://surface.syr.edu/lerner/239.

## Works in Progress

Harrington Meyer, Madonna and **Anna De La Paz**, "'Hey, There's No Food Over Here:' Low Income Grandparenting and Food Insecurity." *Under Review*

Gallo-Cruz, Selina and **Anna De La Paz**, "Framing and Counterframing: Policy Responses to the Commercial Sex Trade." *Under Review*

## Dissertation

"Doula Care in New York: Comparing Medicaid and Private-Pay Systems"
I examine how payer systems shape the administrative, economic, and practice dimensions of doula work in New York State, drawing on 40 interviews. Data collection is nearly complete, and I am currently drafting a chapter.

## Refereed Conference Presentations

**De La Paz, Anna**. October 2026. ""Covered but Uncompensated: How Medicaid Payment Structures Shape the Doula Labor Market"," 3rd Virtual Global on Reproduction, "Worlds of Birth" hosted by Georgetown University

Harrington Meyer, Madonna, and **Anna De La Paz**. August 2026. "'I'm Going to Make Sure the Kids Eat Even If I Don't:' Low-Income Grandparenting and Food Insecurity," American Sociological Association, New York, New York

Harrington Meyer, Madonna, and **Anna De La Paz**. June 2026. "How Food Insecurity Reshapes Patterns of Grandparenting," Working Family Research Network, Montreal, Canada

**De La Paz, Anna**. June 2026. "How does Health Insurance Impact Breastfeeding Initiation?" International Association of Maternal Action + Scholarship (IAMAS), Montreal, Canada

Harrington Meyer, Madonna, and **Anna De La Paz**. May 2026. "The Cost of Care: Food Insecurity and Economic Hardships among Low-Income Grandparents in the U.S." Reimagining the Economics of Late Life Institutions, Systems, and Investments Conference, New York University, New York, New York

**De La Paz, Anna**. March 2025. "Ideologies Around Doula Work: A Literature Review." Eastern Sociological Society Annual Meeting, Boston, Massachusetts

Harrington Meyer, Madonna, and **Anna De La Paz**. September 2024. "Grandparenting and Food Insecurity in the U.S." Refereed paper presented at the Aging and Social Change Conference, University of Galway, Galway, Ireland

**De La Paz, Anna**. July 2024. "Exploring Breastmilk as a Commodified Entity." Global Conference in Women's Studies (WOMENSCONF), Zürich, Switzerland

**De La Paz, Anna**. June 2024. "Exploring Breastmilk as a Commodified Entity." The Agriculture, Food and Human Values Society (AFHVS), Association for the Study of Food and Society (ASFS), Syracuse, New York

## Teaching Experience

**Syracuse University**

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| Instructor, SOC 305: Sex and Gender | Winter 2026 |
| Instructor, SOC/WGS 281: Sociology of Family | Summer 2026 |
| TA, Sociology of Sex & Gender, Dr. Madonna Harrington Meyer | Summer 2024 |
| TA, SOC 300: Global Capitalism, Dr. Edwin Ackerman | Fall 2024 |
| TA, SOC 318: Introduction to Research, Dr. Rebecca Schewe | Spring 2023 |

**Guest Lectures at Syracuse University**

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| "Mental Health, Depression, in Old Age" SOC/WGS 364/664 Aging and Society, Dr. Madonna Harrington Meyer | 2026 |
| "What to Expect in Grad School" PhD Proseminar, Dr. Jennifer Karas Montez | 2026 |
| "Nutrition and Aging: Global Perspective" SOC 400: Global Perspectives on Population Health and Aging, Dr. Haowei Wang | 2025 |
| "Exploring the Complexities of Breastmilk as a Commodified Entity" Food Studies 706: Gender, Food, Rights, Dr. Anne C. Bellows | 2025 |
| "What to Expect in Grad School" PhD Proseminar, Dr. Rick Welsh, Syracuse University | 2025 |
| "Nutrition and Aging: Global Perspective" SOC 400: Global Perspectives on Population Health and Aging, Dr. Professor Haowei Wang | 2024 |
| "Global Capitalism: A Comprehensive Review" SOC 300: Global Capitalism, Dr. Edwin Ackerman | 2024 |
| "Applying Quantitative Methods in Sociological Research" SOC 318: Introduction to Research, Dr. Rebecca Schewe | 2023 |

## Awards

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| Roscoe Martin Fund for Graduate Research $1000 | 2026 |
| Scholarship Recipient, Robin Elise Weiss Doula Training Program | 2025 |
| Emerging Scholars Award, Aging and Social Change Conference, Galway, Ireland | 2024 |

## Service

*Syracuse University*

Maxwell Center for Policy Research Student Representative 2026 - 2027

*To the discipline*

Student Representative of the ASA Aging and the Life Course Section 2026 - 2027

Co-Chair, ASA Student Forum Advisory Board (SFAB) 2026 - 2027

Co-Chair, ASA Student Forum Advisory Board (SFAB) Workshop Committee 2026 - 2027

Vice Chair, ASA Student Forum Advisory Board (SFAB) 2025 - 2026

Ad hoc reviewer for Renewable Agriculture and Food Systems Journal 2026

Session Moderator, Aging and Social Change Conference, Galway, Ireland 2024

## Affiliations

American Sociological Association
- Aging and the Life Course Section
- Family Section

Sociologists for Women in Society
International Association of Maternal Action + Scholarship
Gerontological Society of America (GSA)
Work and Family Researchers Network (WFRN)

## Technical Skills

Statistical software: Stata, SPSS

Data sets: CDC NCHS Natality Public Use File, National Survey of Family Growth (NSFG), General Social Survey (GSS)